

CE 310 — Week 15 Assignment: Capstone Presentation Preparation

CE 310 | Groups of 4 | Presentation in Week 16

Your Week 16 presentation is worth **50 points** of your capstone grade — half of it, and the largest single piece of the whole project. This document describes what to prepare. The grading rubric is in Capstone/Cap.06_Presentation_Rubric.md.

How to Submit

Read this before you submit. Following this submission format exactly is essential — with a class this size, grading depends on it. Submissions that don't comply will be penalized.

Requirement	Detail
File format	PDF — the briefing slide first, any backup slides after it, one file
Team submission	One team member submits on behalf of the whole team. List all four names on the title slide.
File name	lastname1_lastname2_lastname3_lastname4_week15_slides (alphabetical by last name)
Submission	Upload to D2L → Assignments at least 24 hours before your assigned presentation session (Mon Dec 7 or Wed Dec 9)

What You Are Delivering

A **one-slide, 2-minute briefing** followed by **3.5 minutes of questions**, to your classmates and the instructor. Imagine you are a junior engineering consultant with two minutes of your client's attention: you get one finding across, and then you answer for it.

Your team has already delivered the detail twice — the notebook holds the analysis, the report explains it to the client. This is the shortest form of the same work, and the skill is different: decide what matters most, and be able to defend it without notes.

Slide Requirements

One slide is presented. It carries four things:

Must include	Notes
The finding	The single most important thing your analysis established — not the method
The number that supports it	One figure, with units, that your notebook actually produced
The uncertainty around it	Your MC P10–P90 range, or your bootstrap CI — one of them
The recommendation	Specific and quantified, addressed to your client

Backup slides are encouraged. Put anything you might want on screen during questions — the Model 1 vs Model 2 table, the t-test output, a residual plot — after the briefing slide in the same PDF. They are not presented and not scored as content, and having them ready is the difference between answering a question and describing one.

Submission on D2L (due 24 hours before your session)

Submit the PDF — the briefing slide, then your backup slides.

Group Work Expectations

One or two of you deliver the two-minute briefing — there is no requirement to split it four ways, and four people reading in turn is worse than one person speaking well.

All four of you answer. Questions are directed by name, one to each member. The briefing and the questions are one 38-point score — nearly twice what the report is worth — and the answers carry the bulk of it. Expect to be asked *why* a result came out the way it did, not just what it was. If you did not do a part of the analysis yourself, you still have to be able to account for it, so walk each other through your sections before Wednesday.

If you do not know, say so and offer what you do know. That scores better than a confident guess, and much better than a number you invented.

Presentation Tips

- **Quantify everything.** “The GROUP coefficient is 3.5 units per hour” is better than “the two groups differ.”
- **Connect to the client.** Your slides should explain what the numbers mean for your specific stakeholder, not just report them.
- **If your GROUP coefficient's sign is counterintuitive**, that's usually your most compelling finding — explain the mechanism, don't hide it.
- **If your coefficient seems unusually large**, check for confounding (does your grouping variable overlap with something seasonal or cyclical in your predictor?) and explain what you found either way.
- **Small coefficients are not bad results.** A weak relationship can still be a real, useful finding — explain what it means for your client's decision.